

# Ankle Pain - Female (Adult)

Algorithm 1446 | Adult (18 years and older) | Gender at birth: Female

## Definition

- UAT-only adult and pediatric non-traumatic ankle-pain pathway screening for joint infection, systemic illness, inability to bear weight and neurovascular compromise before in-person assessment.
- Adult patient.
- Female.

## Initial assessment

1. [LOCATION] Where exactly is the pain?
2. [DURATION] How long has the pain lasted?
3. [YES\_NO] Is the skin around the ankle swollen and hot?
4. [OPEN\_TEXT] What is the age; is there pregnancy/postpartum status, inability to bear weight, systemic illness, diabetes/immune risk, hidden injury, neurovascular change, or "in a child" refusal to use the limb or safeguarding concern?

## Triage and redirect questions

### **1. Redirect → Motor Vehicle Accident**

Did this problem begin with a motor vehicle crash or as part of a multi-system crash injury?

A motor vehicle crash or multi-system crash injury belongs in the Motor Vehicle Accident pathway.

### **1. Disposition level 100**

Is ankle pain severe with inability to bear weight, neurovascular change, or a hot swollen joint plus marked systemic illness, confusion, breathing change, collapse or rapid deterioration?

Severe functional loss, neurovascular compromise, or marked systemic deterioration requires emergency assessment through the Qatar pathway.

### **1. Disposition level 70**

With no emergency feature, is there any persistent or unexplained ankle pain, hot swelling, functional limitation, child joint concern or higher-risk context?

This UAT pathway requires in-person assessment and does not authorize remote diagnosis, fixed medication advice or pediatric self-care.

## Advice

### **Qatar emergency ankle-joint response**

- Call Qatar emergency services on 999 for a hot swollen joint with systemic illness, severe pain, inability to bear weight, deformity, a cold/pale/blue/numb foot, or rapid deterioration. Do not allow self-driving or force movement. Call Qatar 999 now, follow the call-taker's ambulance and emergency-transport instructions, and do not self-drive. Do not delay emergency care.
- Call Back If: increasing swelling or redness; fever or systemic illness; cannot bear weight.

### **In-person ankle assessment**

- Arrange in-person assessment through an approved Qatar adult or pediatric pathway. Protect the joint and use wrapped cold briefly if comfortable. Do not provide fixed-dose analgesia until age, weight, pregnancy, allergies, kidney/liver disease and interactions are checked under an approved pathway.
- Call Back If: pain or swelling worsens; redness, fever or inability to bear weight.

## First aid

- Call Qatar emergency services on 999 for a hot swollen joint with systemic illness, severe pain, inability to bear weight, deformity, a cold/pale/blue/numb foot, or rapid deterioration. Do not allow self-driving or force movement. Call Qatar 999 now, follow the call-taker's ambulance and emergency-transport instructions, and do not self-drive. Do not delay emergency care.

## References

- NHS.UK, "Joint pain" (non-injury pain guidance), <https://www.nhs.uk/conditions/joint-pain/> (page last reviewed 26 February 2026) - applied to non-traumatic ankle pain

## Provenance

Shaped to mirror the licensed After-Hours Telehealth Triage Guidelines database structure. This is IST open-source guideline content derived from cited public sources; it is not licensed STCC content. Question.DispositionLevel=null marks a See More Appropriate Guideline redirect. Demographic variants contain only source-supported differences; identical thresholds are documented rather than fabricated. Local destinations and TelemedicineEligible values require IST clinical governance approval. UAT DATA ONLY - NOT FOR REAL-PATIENT CARE OR PRODUCTION USE.

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